

MONETIZATION VS. MOMENTUM

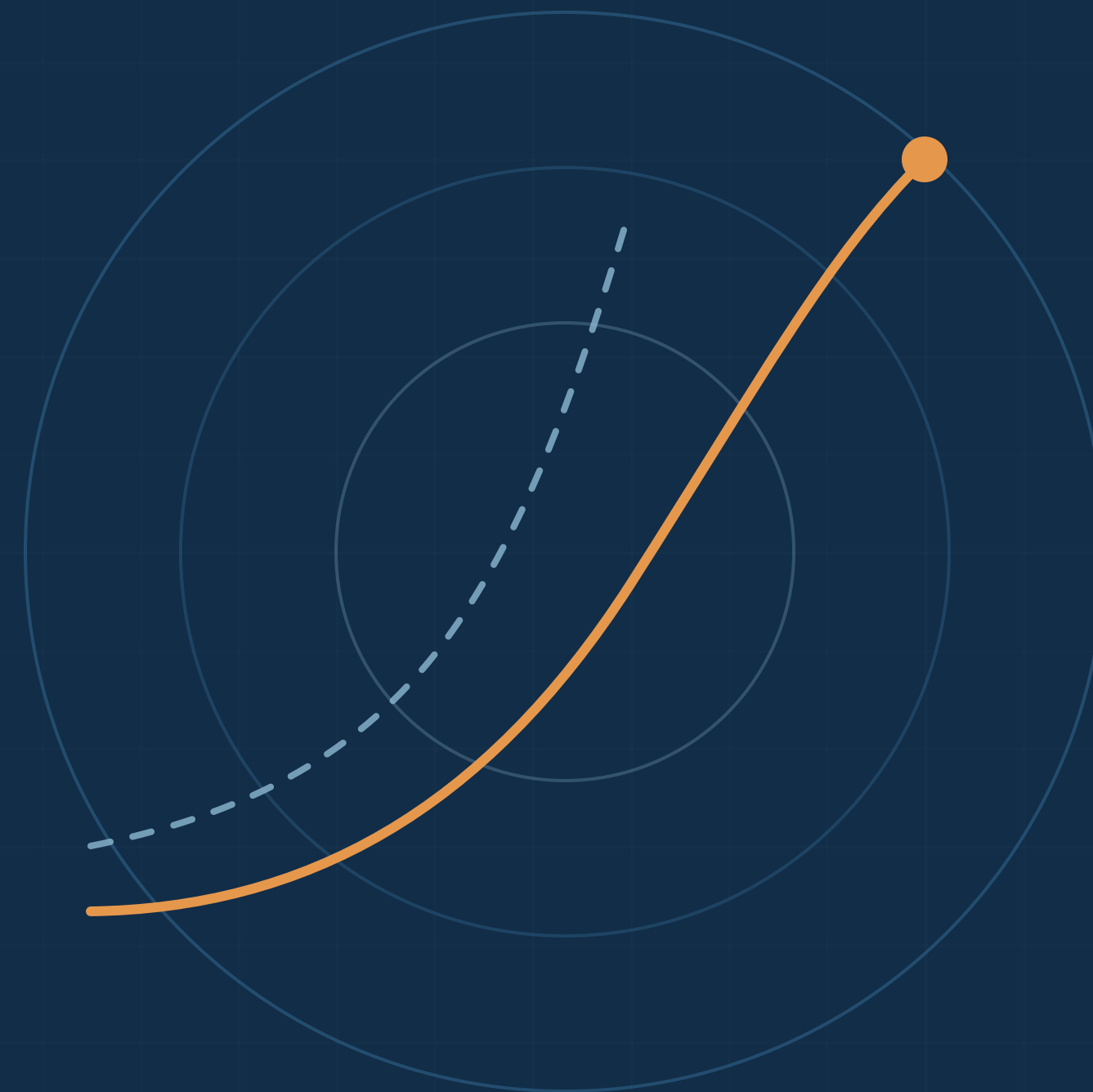
What does success actually look like in modern SaaS?

Growth headlines say one thing. Real earnings say another. Here is what 1,000 real startups tracked by TrustMRR reveal about growth that actually pays.

\$15.6M

combined 30-day revenue across the dataset

1,000 startups · 65 countries · 29 categories



THE DATASET

1,000 Startups. 65 Countries. One Consistent Scoreboard.

One methodology, applied to every company — so the comparisons that follow are like-for-like.



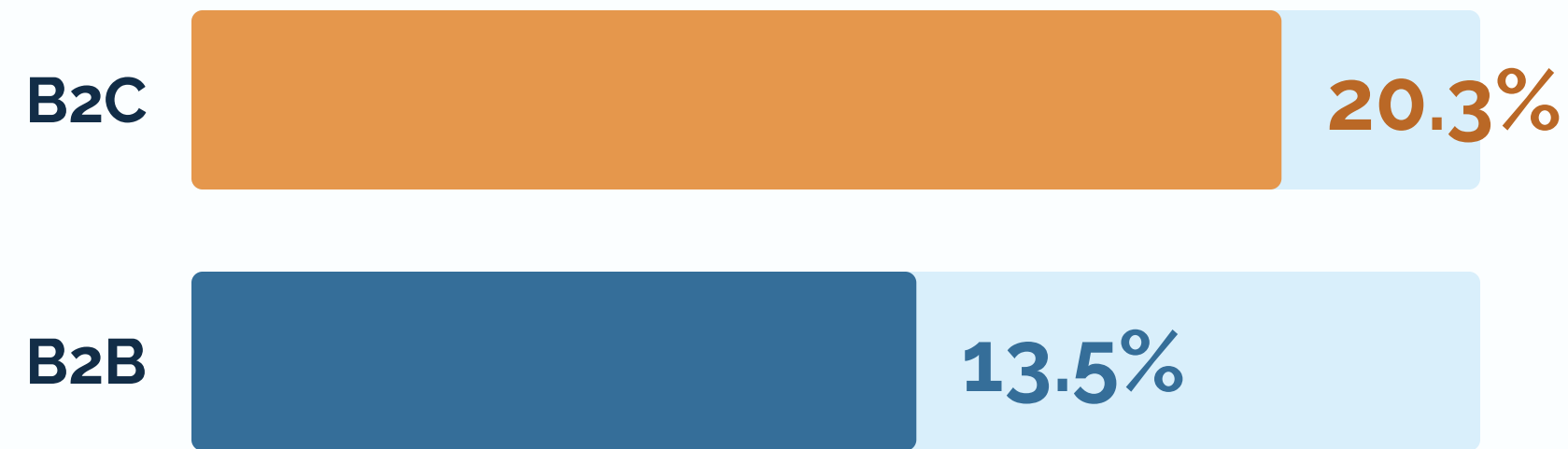
AUDIENCE TYPE SPLIT



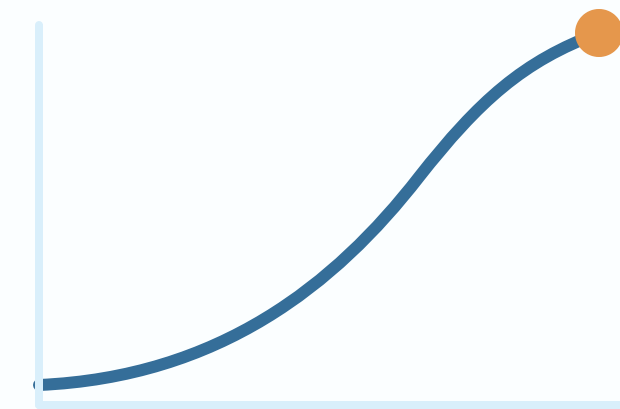
● B2C	401
● B2B	255
● Both	56
● Unclassified	288

The Growth Illusion: B2C Outpaces B2B by Nearly 50%

On average, consumer startups post 20.3% mean monthly MRR growth versus 13.5% for B2B — on growth rate alone, B2C looks like the winning strategy.



Mean monthly MRR growth rate



A growth-rate chart flatters whoever starts from the smallest base. It says nothing about what those customers are worth.

SO WHAT This is the number most people stop reading at — and it's misleading.

THE REVEAL

But B2B Turns Fewer Customers Into 5.7x More Revenue

B2B startups serve fewer median subscribers than B2C, yet earn 5.7x higher median MRR and extract roughly 5x more revenue per subscriber.

Median subscribers
B2B HAS FEWER

16 vs **19**
B2B B2C

Median MRR
5.7X HIGHER

\$1,036 vs **\$181**
B2B B2C

Revenue per subscriber
~5X MORE

\$49 vs **\$9**
B2B B2C

REVENUE PER SUBSCRIBER

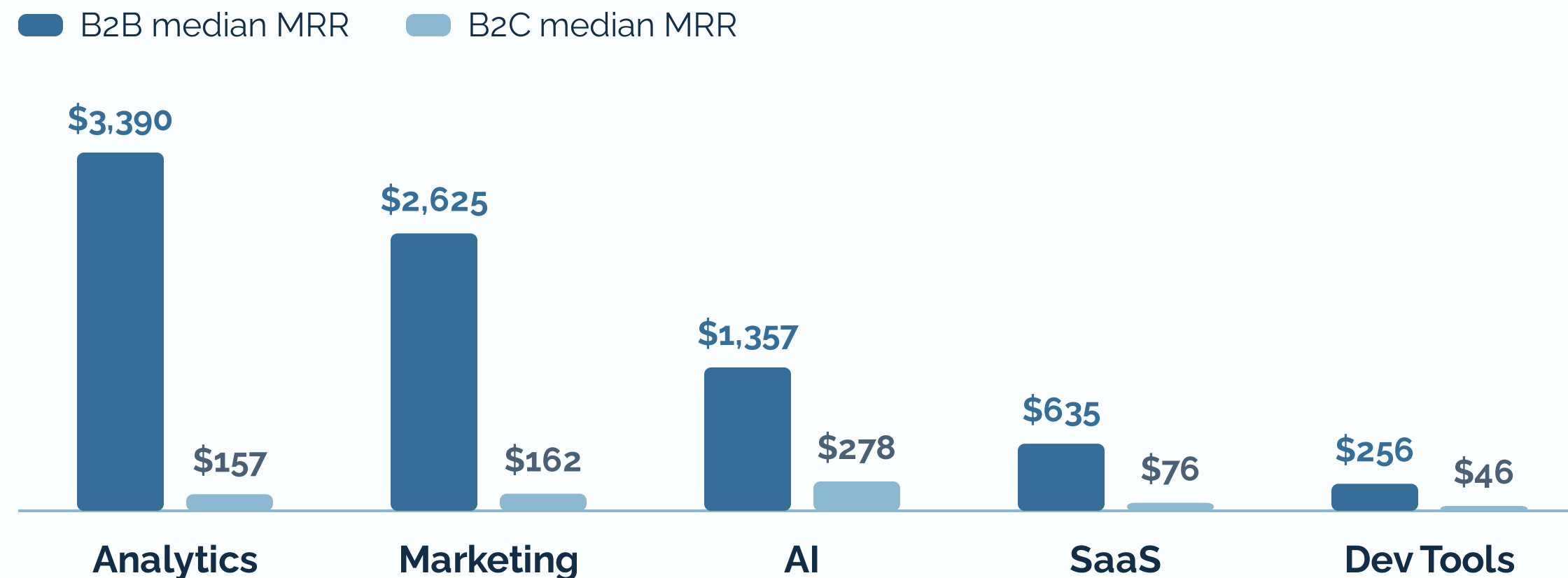


Median MRR divided by median subscriber count.

SO WHAT The B2B “edge” isn’t more customers — it’s what each customer is worth.

The Pattern Holds Inside the Same Market, Not Just Across Different Ones

Comparing B2B and B2C median MRR within the same category, B2B wins 5 of 7 comparable categories — by up to 22x.



WIDEST GAP

22X

Largest B2B-over-B2C median MRR multiple inside a single category.

EXCEPTIONS

Content Creation and E-commerce — the two categories where B2C out-earns B2B.

SO WHAT This rules out “B2B just picks richer markets” — it’s a behavioral pattern, not a category effect.

Followers and Traffic Barely Predict Revenue

X/Twitter followers vs. 30-day revenue: $r = 0.02$ ($n = 984$) — essentially zero. Site visitors vs. revenue: only $r = 0.16$ ($n = 178$).



HIGH TRAFFIC

28.8M

monthly visitors

\$27,505

monthly revenue

TRUSTMRR

73,000

monthly visitors — 400x
less traffic

\$39,795

monthly revenue

400x less traffic, and still the higher earner.

SO WHAT Attention is cheap. Converting it into paying customers is the actual skill.

Recommendations for Founders and Investors

☆ Founders

- 01 Price for value, not volume.
- 02 Don't over-invest in traffic before proving revenue-per-customer.
- 03 Find the “B2B inside your B2C” — power users and teams.
- 04 Track MRR-per-subscriber as a core metric.

🔍 Investors

- 01 Discount follower and traffic metrics in diligence.
- 02 Ask for revenue-per-customer, not just growth rate.
- 03 Treat a B2B pivot or tier as a legitimate monetization lever.
- 04 Pair headline MRR growth % with subscriber count before underwriting it.

Growth Gets the Headlines. Monetization Builds the Company.

5.7x

higher median MRR for B2B

~5x

more revenue per customer

$r \approx 0.02$

correlation with vanity metrics

Based on 1,000 startups tracked by TrustMRR across 65 countries and 29 categories.